

Ἀρχέστρατος ὁ Γελῆς

Archestratus of Gela and the Gastronomic Journey

eul_aid: gtu

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Ἑπική](#) [Epic \(Homeric\)](#) (frg)
Domain: [Ποίησης](#) [Poetry](#)
Format: [Ἑμμετρος](#) [Verse](#)

Archestratus of Gela was a Greek poet from Sicily who lived in the mid-4th century BCE. He traveled extensively through the Greek world to cities famed for their food, including Athens and Byzantium, gathering the firsthand gastronomic knowledge that informed his work. Beyond his origin and travels, few biographical details survive.

His sole known work is the Hedypatheia, or "Life of Luxury," a didactic hexameter poem on gastronomy that survives in approximately 60 fragments. It offers practical advice on sourcing the finest ingredients and their simple preparation. Archestratus is significant as the author of the earliest known Greek cookbook or gastronomic treatise. His poem uniquely blends the didactic epic tradition with the subject of luxurious dining, earning him the later epithet "the Hesiod of tasty dishes."

His work was a major source for Athenaeus, who preserves most fragments in his *Deipnosophistae*. The poem provides valuable insights into 4th-century BCE foodways, trade, and cultural attitudes toward luxury.

Works (2)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα καὶ Τίτλοι](#) · [Fragments and Titles](#) · 302 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Gastronomic Journey Fragments](#) · 310 passages